TSHIAMO'S HOPE FOUNDATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK YOUR MEDICAL TEAM

You are allowed to ask, and you deserve clear answers

Before You Ask

- No question is too small — you are your baby's most important advocate
- Doctors and nurses expect questions; asking helps everyone give better care
- Write down answers in the moment, since it's easy to forget details later
- Bring this list to ward rounds, or hand it to your care team directly

ABOUT MY BABY'S CURRENT CONDITION

Q: What is my baby's current diagnosis or main challenges?

Notes:

Q: What do today's vital signs and test results mean?

Notes:

Q: What are the biggest concerns right now?

Notes:

Q: What changes should I watch for or report to you?

Notes:

Q: How does today compare with yesterday?

Notes:

ABOUT FEEDS & GROWTH

Q: How is my baby's weight gain tracking?

Notes:

Q: What type of feed is my baby on, and why this one?

Notes:

Q: When might we move toward breast or bottle feeding?

Notes:

Q: What signs would show a feed isn't being tolerated?

Notes:

ABOUT MEDICATIONS & PROCEDURES

Q: What is this medication for, and what are the possible side effects?

Notes:

Q: What is this test or procedure checking for?

Notes:

Q: How and when will we find out the results?

Notes:

Q: Are there any risks I should know about beforehand?

Notes:

ABOUT EQUIPMENT & MONITORING

Q: What does each machine or monitor next to my baby do?

Notes:

Q: What do the different alarms mean, and when should I be concerned?

Notes:

Q: Why is my baby on this specific support (ventilator, CPAP, oxygen)?

Notes:

ABOUT MY ROLE AS A PARENT

Q: When can I hold my baby, or start kangaroo care?

Notes:

Q: How can I help with feeds, nappy changes, or bathing?

Notes:

Q: Is there anything I can bring from home for my baby?

Notes:

Q: How can I best support my baby's development right now?

Notes:

ABOUT THE ROAD AHEAD

Q: What milestones need to happen before discharge?

Notes:

Q: What is a realistic timeline, even if it's just an estimate?

Notes:

Q: What specialists might be involved in my baby's ongoing care?

Notes:

Q: What should I expect in the first weeks once we're home?

Notes:

ABOUT SUPPORT FOR ME

Q: Are there support groups or counselling services available here?

Notes:

Q: Who can I contact with questions after hours?

Notes:

Q: What resources are available for financial or logistical support?

Notes:

Understanding your baby's journey is part of walking it alongside them. With love and hope, Tshiamo's Hope Foundation